

Star Wars Again

Star Wars movies to be launched in Blu-ray in 2011 for the 35th anniversary of the release of A New Hope

Intel N550

Netbooks powered by Intel's Atom N550 processors launched in the market

A There is a product called the Spokeman Personal Voice Amplifier. You can contact Paramount Systems & Solutions for more information.

Q 3G touchscreen for under ₹8,000

I want to buy a 3G/touchscreen cell-phone. My budget is between ₹5,000 and 8,000. I choose Micromax H360 and Q7. Please review these for me and suggest a better multimedia set under my budget.

Krishna Singh

A Looking at the specifications of the two phones you have mentioned, Micromax H360 and Micromax Q7, I feel you should go for the Q7. Reason being with a 3G phone it makes more sense to have a QWERTY keypad than a regular one. Also, Q7 is comparatively cheaper than H360. On the downside though, the Q7 has a 2 MP camera, whereas H360 has a 3 MP camera

Q Upgrading GPU

I have an HP Pavilion a1515in Media Center Desktop PC with configuration as follows: Intel Pentium 4 Processor 524 clocked at 3.06 GHz, 2 GB Kingston DDR2 RAM, 80 GB 7200 RPM hard drive, onboard ATI Radeon Xpress 200 GPU, Windows XP Media Center Edition. I want to buy a discreet GPU for my PC. I contacted HP to inquire about what type of GPU will it support (ie DDR2, DDR3 etc) to which he answered that there's a PCI x16 slot vacant in the motherboard and any PCI x16 compatible GPU, irrespective of whether it is DDR2 or DDR3 will be



supported. I wanted to confirm whether what he told me is correct or not.

Another thing I wanted to know is that since Sapphire Radeon HD 4670 I was rated best performer by Digit in July 2010 issue, I was planning to buy that as

it suits my budget too which is between ₹3,500 to 5,000, so will I have to upgrade my PSU which is currently of 300W? If yes, then please suggest me a decent PSU that should suffice my requirement. Also, please tell me what is the minimum frame rate for a game to be termed as "playable", so that it doesn't stutter.

Jagrit Chawla

A Pretty much any modern day graphics card should work on the motherboard. The Radeon 4670 fits in your budget and the power supply should just about suffice. In case you're facing constant crashes and reboots, you can upgrade to a Corsair VX450. A minimum frame rate of 30 - 40 fps can be considered smooth and playable.

Q eSATA or Firewire drive?

I am thinking of buying an external hard drive of 320 GB or 500 GB size. Can you suggest me some drive of both 2.5-inch portable or a 3.5-inch external (what is performance difference between the two types). I want to go for a WD or a Seagate drive.

I have a Dell Studio 15, which has a e-SATA and a Firewire port. I know that both give higher speeds than the USB, but I am not sure about the use of Firewire port in Windows OS, as I heard that Firewire works with Apple's OS only.

Vishal Rawat

A 5-inch drives are faster than 2.5-inch drives. On USB, almost all the drives perform at around 30 - 32 MB/s. Go for cheaper drive and one that gives you a better warranty. If you're looking for 3.5-inch drives, look for the Seagate FreeAgent Desk 500GB external drives.

From what we've seen, eSATA offers far superior performance than even Firewire drives. Firewire is also available on PCs running Windows and not just for Macs.



Q Need to buy a good 3G phone

I need a good 3G phone so that I don't need to use my laptop all the time for internet access. I want to access Facebook, Twitter and play Mafia Wars from my phone. Its battery life should be good enough to listen to songs and watch videos. Also, I was thinking of buying a touchscreen 3G-phone. I read a piece where you didn't recommend buying a touch phone below ₹22,000. Since my budget is very low, I can't spend more than ₹11,000. I want the phone to have good video playback and a camera with flash, at as low price as possible. How much will I have to pay for the same features on a touchscreen phone?

Ankit Prateek

A The price range you have is a bit on the lower side for a 3G touchscreen cellphone. Moreover, it will be difficult to say which the best 3G phone is as we have yet to start using the 3G network to fully grasp its advantages and shortcomings. However, we would like to suggest some phones around your price bracket.

1. Samsung Lindy M5650 priced around ₹11,000, has WiFi and 3G and it is touchscreen. It looks like the Corby phones but doesn't belong to that family.
2. Samsung S3370 Nano priced around ₹7,000 has support for 3G but ordinary camera and features
3. Micromax Q7 is priced around ₹5,000 and is 3G ready but it has a QWERTY keypad.
4. INQ Chat 3G phones are priced considerably cheaper, only issue is that they have a QWERTY keypad.
5. LG GW525 is a touchscreen with a slider keypad priced around ₹11,000 which supports 3G.

Q Which 12-core processor?

I'm building my own ultra high-end gaming PC. For the CPU, I want a 12-core CPU. Please suggest a good one and also mention the type of socket it uses.

A There are no 12-core processors for desktops. Intel and AMD, both have 6-core processors. They are the Intel Core i7 980X and AMD Phenom II X6 1090T. **D**